

PAUL OHM

Georgetown University Law Center

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EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University Law Center, Professor, 2015 – Present; Chief Data Officer, 2020 – Present

Prior Positions: Associate Dean for Academic Affairs, 2018 – 2021; Associate Dean for the Office of the Registrar, 2021 – 2022

Other Affiliations: Center on Privacy and Technology, Faculty Associate, 2015 – Present; Institute for Technology Law and Policy, Faculty Director, 2016 – Present; Technology & Society Initiative, Chair, 2021 – 2023, Steering Committee Member, 2023 – Present

University of Colorado Law School, Associate Dean for Academic Affairs and Associate Professor (tenured 2011); Silicon Flatirons Center, Director of IT/IP Initiative; and LL.M Co-Director, 2006 – 2015

(Related appointments: Associate Professor (courtesy), Interdisciplinary Telecommunications Program (Department of Engineering))

Federal Trade Commission, Senior Policy Advisor, 2012 – 2013

United States Department of Justice, Computer Crime and Intellectual Property Section, Honors Program Trial Attorney, 2001 – 2005

Hon. Betty Binns Fletcher, U.S. Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit, Law Clerk, 2000 – 2001

Hon. Mariana Pfaelzer, U.S. District Court for the Central District of California, Law Clerk, 1999 – 2000

RAND Corporation, Computer Programmer, 1994 – 1996

ARTICLES

Superwarrants, 67 ARIZONA LAW REVIEW ____ (forthcoming 2026) (with Susan Freiwald).

Focusing Privacy Law, 40 BERKELEY TECH. L.J. 391 (2025).

Fact and Friction: A Case Study in the Fight Against False News, 57 UC DAVIS LAW REVIEW 171 (2023) with Ayelet Gordon-Tapiero and Ashwin Ramaswami).

Legacy Switches: A Proposal to Protect Privacy, Security, and the Environment from the Internet of Things, 84 OHIO STATE LAW JOURNAL 101 (2023) (with Nate Kim).

The Many Revolutions of Carpenter, 32 HARVARD JOURNAL OF LAW AND TECHNOLOGY 357 (2019). (honored as one of top five policy-relevant privacy law papers by the Future of Privacy Forum).

Desirable Inefficiency, 70 FLORIDA L. REV. 777 (2018) (with Jonathan Frankle).

Sensitive Information, 88 SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA LAW REV. 1125 (2015).

Branding Privacy, 97 MINNESOTA LAW REVIEW 907 (2013).

Broken Promises of Privacy: Responding to the Surprising Failure of Anonymization, 57 UCLA LAW REVIEW 1701-1777 (2010).

The Rise and Fall of Invasive ISP Surveillance, 2009 UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS LAW REVIEW 1417-1496 (2009).

The Myth of the Superuser: Fear, Risk, and Harm Online, 41 U.C. DAVIS LAW REVIEW 1327-1402 (2008).

SELECTED
SYMPOSIA AND
OTHER SHORTER
WORKS

Limiting Reverse Searches in the Stored Communications Act, Lawfare Research Report 26-7.

Toward Compliance Zero: AI and the Vanishing Costs of Regulatory Compliance in THE LAW & TECHNOLOGY & ECONOMICS OF AI (Adrian Kuenzler, Thibault Schrepel & Volker Stocker eds.), NETWORK LAW REVIEW, Summer 2025.

Focusing on Fine-Tuning: Understanding the Four Pathways for Shaping Generative AI, 25 COLUM. SCI. & TECH. L. REV. 214 (2024).

Voting for Consent, 104 B.U.L. REV. 1107 (2024) (with Meg Jones).

Governance Seams, 37 HARVARD JOURNAL OF LAW AND TECHNOLOGY 1117 (forthcoming 2023) (with Brett Frischmann).

The Computer Fraud and Abuse Act After *Van Buren*, 5 AMER. CONST. SOC'Y SUP. CT. REV. 181 (2021).

Illusory Conflicts: Post-Employment Clearance Procedures and the FTC's Technological Expertise, 35 BERKELEY TECHNOLOGY LAW JOURNAL 793 (2020) (with Lindsey Barrett, Laura Moy, and Ashkan Soltani).

Throttling Machine Learning in LIFE AND THE LAW IN THE ERA OF DATA-DRIVEN AGENCY (Mireille Hildebrandt and Kieran O'Hara eds.) (2019).

Forthright Code, 56 HOUSTON L. REV. 471 (2018) (invited lecture).

Regulating at Scale, 2 GEO. L. TECH. REV. 546 (2018).

The Investigative Dynamics of the Use of Malware by Law Enforcement, 26 W&M BILL OF RIGHTS J. 303 (2017).

Playing With the Data: What Legal Scholars Should Learn About Machine Learning, 51 U.C. DAVIS L. REV. 653 (2017) (with David Lehr).

We Couldn't Kill the Internet If We Tried, 130 HARVARD LAW REVIEW FORUM 79 (2016) (online commentary).

Regulating Software When Everything Has Software, 84 GEORGE WASHINGTON UNIVERSITY LAW REVIEW 1672 (2016) (symposium) (with Blake Reid).

What if Everything Reveals Everything? (with Scott Peppet), in BIG DATA IS NOT A MONOLITH (Cassidy Sugimoto, Michael Mattioli, and Hamid Ekbia) (2016).

The Surveillance Regulation Toolkit: Thinking Beyond Probable Cause, in THE CAMBRIDGE HANDBOOK OF SURVEILLANCE LAW (Stephen Henderson and David Gray, eds) (2016).

The Computer Fraud and Abuse Act: Structure, Controversy, and Proposals for Reform in CYBER INSECURITY: NAVIGATING THE PERILS OF THE NEXT INFORMATION AGE (Richard M. Harrison and Dr. Trey Herr, eds.) (2016).

The Life of Riley (v. California), 48 TEX. TECH. L. REV. 133 (2015) (symposium).

What Do the Rules Say About Data Analysis? *in* BIG DATA, PRIVACY, AND THE PUBLIC GOOD: FRAMEWORKS FOR ENGAGEMENT (Cambridge University Press) (Julia Lane, et al. eds.) (2014).

The Underwhelming Benefits of Big Data, 161 UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA LAW REVIEW ONLINE 339 (2013) (responding to Paul M. Schwartz, Information Privacy in the Cloud) (online journal).

The Fourth Amendment in a World Without Privacy, 81 MISSISSIPPI LAW JOURNAL 1309 (2012) (symposium).

The Argument Against Technology Neutral Surveillance Laws, 87 TEXAS LAW REVIEW 1685-1713 (2010) (symposium).

Probably Probable Cause: The Diminishing Importance of Justification Standards, 93 MINNESOTA LAW REVIEW 1514-1560 (2010) (symposium).

Computer Programming and the Law: A New Research Agenda, 54 VILLANOVA LAW REVIEW 117-153 (2009).

Good Enough Privacy, 2008 UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO LEGAL FORUM 1-63 (symposium).

COURSES
TAUGHT

Georgetown University Law Center: Artificial Intelligence Law, Computer Crime Law, Computer Programming for Lawyers: An Introduction, Computer Programming for Lawyers: Intermediate, Criminal Justice, Investigating Crime in the Darknet, Information Privacy Law, Technology of Privacy, Technology Impact Lab

University of Colorado Law School: Computer Crime, Copyright, Criminal Procedure, Information Privacy, Introduction to Intellectual Property, Technology of Privacy, Quantitative Methods for Lawyers

Adjunct Professor at Georgetown University Law Center, George Washington University School of Law, American University, Washington College of Law

HONORS

Georgetown University Provost's Innovation in Teaching Award, 2025.

Georgetown University Law Center Steven Goldberg Award for Faculty Service, May 2020.

University of Colorado Provost's Faculty Achievement Award, October 2010 (campuswide recognition of scholarship).

Deiter Meurer Prize for Law and Informatics, Awarded by the German Association for Computing and the Judiciary and Juris, September 2010.

Excellence in Teaching Award, University of Colorado Law School, 2009-10.

Outstanding New Faculty Member, University of Colorado Law School Class of 2008.

EDUCATION

UCLA School of Law, J.D., 1999; UCLA Law Review, Articles Editor; Benjamin Aaron Award; Jerry Pacht Prize

Yale University, B.S., Computer Science, B.A., Electrical Engineering, 1994

GRANTS AND
AWARDS

Public Interest Technology-University Network (PIT-UN) Grant for *Building Bridges: Strengthening Cross-Disciplinary Connections in Computer Science and Law* (2019 – 21)

Ford Foundation, Attorney-General Technology Education Network (2020 – present)

AXA Grant in Big Data, Privacy, and Discrimination (2015-18) (\$300,000).

Cy Pres award from privacy litigation (2011) (\$100,000).

National Science Foundation Grant for Legal Issues on Named Data Networking (2011-13) (\$125,000).

Kauffman Foundation Grant for Software Regulation Clearing House (2006) (\$100,000).

SELECTED
SERVICE

Advisory Board, Knight-Georgetown Institute, 2024 – Present

Board of Directors, The Markup, 2019 – 2024

Board of Directors, Upturn, 2016 – 2023

Commissioner, U.S. Commission on Evidence-Based Policymaking, White House Appointment, 2016 – 2017

Significant University Service: Dean Search Committee (Georgetown, 2025-26; U. Colorado, 2010-11).